

Kennan Lu
CS461
Final Reflection
12/1/2025

I had a great time working on FindMyRide with Samii and Mustafa. We challenged ourselves by picking out a tech stack that we weren't familiar with so that we could pick up and learn new skills, and it ended up being a very fruitful and enjoyable experience that taught me a lot about not just databases, but applications and development as a whole. There were many road bumps encountered in the way of development, as we were very inexperienced with the entire process of building and connecting a database to an application as a team.

It was very interesting to put the database together first before starting development on the application as a whole. It really forced me to learn how to navigate database designs, schema, and create mock data in line that was in line with the schema, and relevant to the premise of the application. Mustafa, having created such a thorough design for our application, made things a lot easier to stomach when it came to designing the whole application. There were a lot of unknowns when it came to using Kotlin to create the screens for the application, but Mustafa having such a detailed design made it incredibly easy to break down the UI and functionalities into smaller, more manageable parts.

Overall, I would consider this project to have been a very successful learning experience for me. There was a ton of time lost to debugging the compilation of the app at runtime and trying to manage the dependencies of a completely different tech stack, but actually having hands-on experience drafting, creating, and populating the database behind the application really helped to reinforce the concepts learned in class. Making it connect to an application was also an especially helpful learning experience from the perspective of a developer seeking to make applications in the future, and I will continue to contribute to projects in the future that help me similarly build skills.